Conversation track 15, 17, 18

Thu and Kieran are waiting for their exam results to go online at noon.

Thu: It's twelve o'clock. Why isn't the results page loading yet?

Kieran: Everyone's refreshing at once. I've been **on edge** all morning.

Thu: Same here. I've had **butterflies in my stomach** since breakfast.

Kieran: Seriously, I'm **fed up with** this website. It crashed last year, too.

Thu: Wait, it's working! Oh my goodness, I actually passed!

Kieran: Way to go! I knew you would. OK, my turn.

Thu: Well? Don't leave me hanging!

Kieran: I passed, too! What **a weight off my shoulders**.

Thu: I'm **over the moon**. I could cry, honestly.

Kieran: Don't, or you'll set me off. Let's go celebrate instead.

Speak Like a Native track 16

1. I've been on edge all morning.

linking: "on_edge_all"
strong: "edge", "morning"

"on edge all" nối liền thành "a-ne-jol". Giọng Mỹ đọc rõ r trong "morning": /ˈmɔːrnɪŋ/.

2. Well? Don't leave me hanging!

change: "Don't leave" (mất âm t)
strong: "Well", "hanging"

"Well?" lên giọng, sốt ruột chờ câu trả lời. Âm t của "Don't" mất trước "leave": "đâun-li:v".

3. What a weight off my shoulders.

linking: "What_a", "weight_off"
strong: "weight", "shoulders"

Giọng Mỹ: t giữa hai nguyên âm thành d nhẹ, "What a" → "wa-đơ", "weight off" → "wei-đóf". Câu cảm thán xuống giọng ở cuối.

- Thành ngữ cảm xúc: nhấn vào từ hình ảnh (EDGE, MOON, WEIGHT), đọc nhẹ giới từ và mạo từ.
- Câu cảm thán What a…! xuống giọng mạnh ở cuối.
- Giọng Anh (Thu): don't, so, go đọc /əʊ/ "âu"; giọng Mỹ (Kieran) đọc /oʊ/ "ôu".
- Câu hỏi một từ (Well?) lên giọng để giục người kia nói tiếp.

Role Play track 20

A: It's twelve o'clock. Why isn't the results page loading yet?

B: Everyone's refreshing at once. I've been _____ all morning.

A: Same here. I've had butterflies in my stomach since breakfast.

B: Seriously, I'm _____ this website. It crashed last year, too.

A: Wait, it's working! Oh my goodness, I actually passed!

B: Way to go! I knew you would. OK, my turn.

A: Well? Don't leave me hanging!

B: I passed, too! What _____.

A: I'm over the moon. I could cry, honestly.

B: Don't, or you'll set me off. Let's go celebrate instead.

Study Notes

Don't leave me hanging!
Đừng bắt mình chờ nữa!
Giục người kia nói ngay kết quả hoặc câu trả lời.
Cách nói tương đương: Don't keep me in suspense!

Don't, or you'll set me off.
Đừng mà, không mình khóc theo bây giờ.
"set someone off" = làm ai bắt đầu khóc (hoặc cười) theo.
Cách nói tương đương: Stop, or I'll start crying too.

Grammar Focus

Thành ngữ chỉ lo lắng, bực bội

on edge, a bundle of nerves (bồn chồn, lo lắng); butterflies in my stomach (hồi hộp); fed up with (chán ngấy, bực mình vì).

She's been **on edge** since the interview.
I always get **butterflies** before a big match.
I'm **fed up with** all this rain.

Thành ngữ chỉ vui mừng, nhẹ nhõm

over the moon, on cloud nine (vui sướng tột độ); a weight off my shoulders (trút được gánh nặng).

She was **over the moon** about the baby.
Paying off the loan was **a weight off my shoulders**.
He's been **on cloud nine** since the wedding.

Substitution Drill track 21

1. I've been **on edge** all morning.
   a. a nervous wreck
   b. a bundle of nerves
   c. climbing the walls

2. Seriously, I'm **fed up with** this website.
   a. sick and tired of
   b. so done with
   c. losing my patience with

3. What **a weight off my shoulders**.
   a. a relief
   b. a load off my mind
   c. a dream come true